

● MEDIUM

● STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

● ANSWER KEY

Form, Structure, and Sense

04

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**A****A. invites**

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb “invites” agrees in number with the singular subject “Tracy Fullerton’s *Walden, a game.*”

Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb “invite” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “Tracy Fullerton’s *Walden, a game.*” Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb “are inviting” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “Tracy Fullerton’s *Walden, a game.*” Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb “have invited” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “Tracy Fullerton’s *Walden, a game.*”

Q2**B****B. developed**

Choice B is the best answer. The missing verb is part of the same clause as the verb “premiered,” and “Price” is the subject of both. So we need the past-tense form “developed” in order to match “premiered.”

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a verb form error. The missing verb is part of the same clause as the verb “premiered,” and “Price” is the subject of both. So we need the past-tense form “developed” in order to match “premiered.” Choice C is incorrect. This choice creates a verb form error. The missing verb is part of the same clause as the verb “premiered,” and “Price” is the subject of both. So we need the past-tense form “developed” in order to match “premiered.” Choice D is incorrect. This choice creates a verb form error. The missing verb is part of the same clause as the verb “premiered,” and “Price” is the subject of both. So we need the past-tense form “developed” in order to match “premiered.”

Q3**D**

D. it

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun–antecedent agreement. The singular pronoun “it” agrees in number with the singular antecedent “violin” and thus indicates that the traditional violin (and not its curves) was made lighter.

Choice A is incorrect because the plural pronoun “those” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “violin.” Choice B is incorrect because the singular pronoun “one” is ambiguous in this context; the resulting sentence leaves unclear what Stradivari made lighter. Choice C is incorrect because the plural pronoun “them” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “violin.”

Q4**A**

A. has entered

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb “has entered” agrees in number with the singular subject “an abstract cubist painting.”

Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb “have entered” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “an abstract cubist painting.” Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb “were entering” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “an abstract cubist painting.” Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb “enter” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “an abstract cubist painting.”

Q5

D

- D. the Alaska Centennial Commission sponsored a contest that would award \$300 to an individual who came
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Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "the Alaska Centennial Commission" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "wanting...Purchase." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that the Alaska Centennial Commission—and not another noun in the sentence—wanted to celebrate the 100th anniversary of the Alaska Purchase.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "a contest" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the contest wanted to celebrate the 100th anniversary of the Alaska Purchase. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "an award of \$300" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the award of \$300 wanted to celebrate the 100th anniversary of the Alaska Purchase. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "\$300" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the \$300 wanted to celebrate the 100th anniversary of the Alaska Purchase.

Q6

C

- C. it
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Choice C is the best answer. "It" is a singular pronoun used to stand in for objects. Since the antecedent in this case is the singular noun phrase "the human brain," "it" is a perfect pronoun to use here.

Choice A is incorrect. Although "she" is a singular pronoun, it is reserved for people and animals, not objects like "the human brain." Choice B is incorrect. "They" is a plural pronoun, but we need a singular pronoun to represent the antecedent "the human brain." Choice D is incorrect. "Those" is a plural pronoun, but we need a singular pronoun to represent the antecedent "the human brain."

Q7

A

A. evokes

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "evokes" agrees in number with the singular subject "Alexander's use."

Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "are evoking" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "Alexander's use." Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "have evoked" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "Alexander's use." Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb "evoke" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "Alexander's use."

Q8

B

B. Anna Behrensmeyer demonstrated in a 2005 analysis that fossils of thin-shelled organisms

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun phrase "Anna Behrensmeyer" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "a pioneer...fossils." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that Anna Behrensmeyer—and not another noun in the sentence—is a pioneer in the field of taphonomy.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "fossils of thin-shelled organisms" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the "fossils" are a pioneer in the field of taphonomy. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the pronoun "it" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that "it" is a pioneer in the field of taphonomy. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "a 2005 analysis" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that "a 2005 analysis" is a pioneer in the field of taphonomy.

Q9

D

D. Rawles

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. When, as in this case, a subject (“Calida Garcia Rawles”) is immediately followed by a verb (“was”), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Q10

C

C. screw’s threads.

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of plural and possessive nouns. The singular possessive noun “screw’s” and the plural noun “threads” correctly indicate that there is only one screw and it has multiple threads.

Choice A is incorrect because the context requires the plural noun “threads,” not the singular possessive noun “thread’s.” Choice B is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun “screw’s,” not the plural possessive noun “screws’.” Choice D is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun “screw’s” and the plural noun “threads,” not the plural noun “screws” or the plural possessive noun “threads.”

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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